

UNIT 1 · TOPIC 1.3

Airline Alliances and Codeshares

How rival airlines cooperate to fly you almost anywhere on one ticket.

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 1: Overview of the Airline Industry
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar

**BOARDING PASS**

LEARNER

STU

PROFESSIONAL

**PRO**

FLIGHT

ATF 1.3

GATE

PERIOD 3

DURATION

00:40

SEAT

SEM III

CLASS

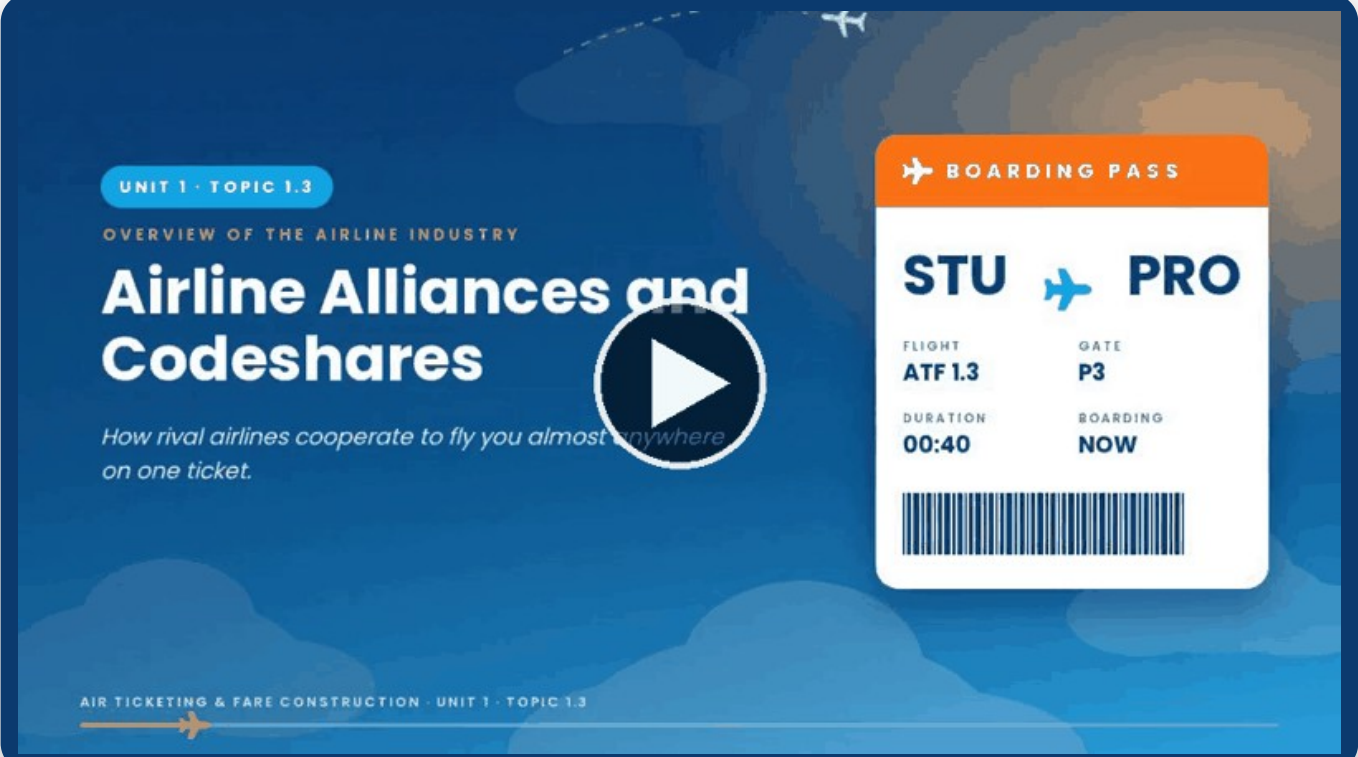
GROUP

BOARDING

NOW

TOPIC 1.3

In-Flight Movie: Topic Intro



The graphic features a dark blue background with a stylized world map and a white play button icon in the center. On the right, there is a white boarding pass for flight ATF 1.3 from STU to PRO, with a duration of 00:40 and boarding time NOW. The boarding pass includes a barcode and the MH Cockpit logo.

UNIT 1 · TOPIC 1.3

OVERVIEW OF THE AIRLINE INDUSTRY

Airline Alliances and Codeshares

How rival airlines cooperate to fly you almost anywhere on one ticket.

BOARDING PASS

STU  **PRO**

FLIGHT **ATF 1.3** GATE **P3**

DURATION **00:40** BOARDING **NOW**

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**02**

TOPIC 1.3

Pre-Flight Question



THINK ABOUT IT

How can you board a Lufthansa aircraft holding an Air India ticket?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2-3 answers with the class



TOPIC 1.3

Today's Flight Plan

1

1.3.1

Introduction to alliances: Star Alliance, SkyTeam and Oneworld

2

1.3.2

Benefits of alliances: shared routes, reduced costs, frequent flyer benefits

3

1.3.3

Codeshare agreements: definition and benefits for airlines and passengers

4

1.3.4

Examples of codeshare flights and how they work

**BY LANDING, YOU WILL**

- Name the three global alliances and key members
- Explain alliance benefits for airlines and flyers
- Define marketing vs operating carrier
- Read a codeshare flight on an itinerary

Pedagogy: Group Teaching and Learning



TOPIC 1.3.1

The Big Three Global Alliances

Together they carry a large share of the world's long-haul travellers.



Star Alliance · 1997

Largest by members (~25).
Founders include Lufthansa,
United, Air Canada, Thai, SAS.
India: Air India (joined 2014).
Also Singapore Airlines, Turkish
Airlines.



SkyTeam · 2000

About 18 members. Founders
Delta, Air France, Aeroméxico,
Korean Air. Also KLM, Virgin
Atlantic, Saudia, Vietnam
Airlines, SAS (2024).



Oneworld · 1999

About 15 members. Founders
include American, British
Airways, Cathay Pacific,
Qantas. Also Qatar Airways,
JAL, SriLankan, Alaska Airlines.



TOPIC 1.3.1

Alliances by the Numbers

Approximate member counts (2025) — check alliance websites for updates.

~25

Star Alliance member airlines

~18

SkyTeam member airlines

~15

Oneworld member airlines



Not every airline is in an alliance: Emirates, IndiGo and many LCCs grow through bilateral codeshares and partnerships instead.

TOPIC 1.3.2

Why Airlines Join Alliances

Cooperation beats building every route alone.



Shared Networks

Sell thousands of destinations without flying there themselves.



Reduced Costs

Shared lounges, terminals, ground handling and joint purchasing.



More Revenue

Feed traffic between partners' hubs and fill more seats.



Brand & Trust

Common service standards reassure global travellers.



TOPIC 1.3.2

What Passengers Gain

For travellers, an alliance feels like one giant airline.

**Through check-in**

Bags checked to the final destination across partner airlines.

**Frequent flyer benefits**

Earn and burn miles on any member; elite status recognised (e.g., Star Gold, SkyTeam Elite Plus, Oneworld Emerald).

**Lounge access**

Top-tier members and premium passengers use partner lounges worldwide.

**ROUND-THE-WORLD**

Alliances sell Round-the-World fares — one ticket, multiple continents, many airlines — something no single airline could offer alone.



TOPIC 1.3.3

Codeshare: Marketing vs Operating Carrier



Marketing Carrier

- Sells the seat under its own flight number
- Its code appears on the ticket
- Handles the booking and ticketing
- Example: an Air India “AI” flight number



Operating Carrier

- Actually flies the aircraft and crew
- Its rules apply at the airport
- Check-in usually with this airline
- Example: Lufthansa aircraft and crew

TOPIC 1.3.3

Who Benefits from Codesharing?



Airlines

Expand network instantly, appear higher in GDS displays, gain connecting traffic at low cost.



Passengers

One ticket, one booking reference, coordinated connections and baggage through-checked.



Watch-outs

Different baggage rules or service standards; passengers must know which airline operates each flight.

TOPIC 1.3.4

Reading a Codeshare on an Itinerary

The “operated by” line is the key clue.

- Two flight numbers can describe one physical flight.
- The ticket shows the marketing carrier’s code.
- Look for “OPERATED BY” to find who flies it.
- Check-in, baggage and seat rules follow the operating carrier.

ITINERARY DISPLAY (illustrative)

```
// Illustrative itinerary
1  AI 8xxx  Y  15NOV  DEL  FRA
   OPERATED BY LUFTHANSA
   LH 761 is the same aircraft

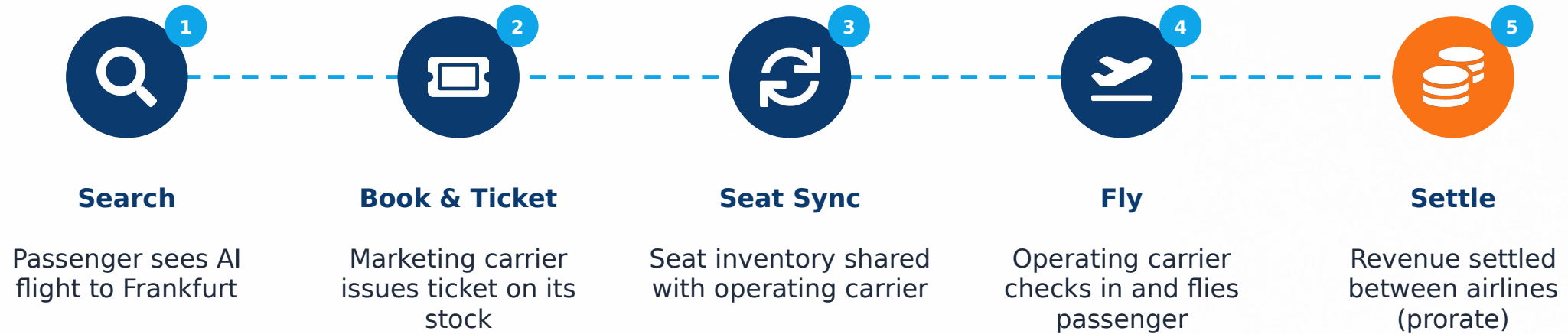
2  6E 4xxx  Y  20NOV  BOM  DOH
   OPERATED BY QATAR AIRWAYS

> Tip: 4-digit numbers are often
> used for codeshare flights
```

TOPIC 1.3.4

How a Codeshare Booking Flows

Behind the scenes, two airlines share one passenger.



TOPIC 1.3

Cabin Crew Activity: Alliance Showdown

**PEDAGOGY****Group Teaching and Learning****TIME · 10 min****FORMAT · Three groups****1**

Split the class into Star Alliance, SkyTeam and Oneworld teams.

2

Each team lists 5 member airlines and 3 hubs (use phones to verify).

3

Plan a DEL → New York → São Paulo → DEL trip using only your alliance.

4

Pitch in 60 seconds: why should a passenger choose your alliance?



TOPIC 1.3*Click to reveal each answer*

Pre-Landing Check

Q1**Air India is a member of which alliance?**

- A) SkyTeam
- B) Oneworld
- C) Star Alliance
- D) None

ANSWER**C****Q2****The airline that actually flies a codeshare flight is the...**

- A) Marketing carrier
- B) Operating carrier
- C) Validating carrier
- D) Charter carrier

ANSWER**B****Q3****Which was a founding member of Oneworld?**

- A) Lufthansa
- B) Delta
- C) British Airways
- D) Emirates

ANSWER**C****Q4****Which is a passenger benefit of alliances?**

- A) Higher taxes
- B) Through check-in of baggage
- C) Separate tickets
- D) No miles

ANSWER**B**

SAFE LANDING

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Three global alliances: Star Alliance, SkyTeam and Oneworld
- ✓ Alliances cut costs, extend networks and reward frequent flyers
- ✓ Codeshare = one flight, two flight numbers (marketing vs operating)
- ✓ Always tell passengers who operates each flight

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT DEPARTURE

Topic 1.4 — Booking Classes and Fare Types

Thank you · Questions?